

WENLAN PAN

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EDUCATION

Johns Hopkins University

B.A. in Psychology; minor in Applied Mathematics and Statistics

Baltimore, MD
Sept 2024 – May 2026

- **GPA:** 3.91/4.0.
- **Awards:** Dean's List (Fall 2024, Spring 2025).

University of California, Davis

Major in Psychology

Davis, CA
Sept 2022 – Jun 2024

- **GPA:** 3.98/4.0.
- **Awards:** Dean's List (Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Winter 2024, Spring 2024); Provost's Undergraduate Fellowship.

PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

Pan, W., Bowen, J., & Seltermann, D. (2026). Across Virtual and Real Worlds: Attachment and Boundary Permeability in Relationships with Virtual Characters. Poster presented at the *Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) 2026 Annual Convention*, Chicago, IL.

Pan, W., & Cox, J. (2025). The Effect of Agreeableness on Stereotypes of Native Speakers: Language Proficiency as a Mediating Factor. Poster presented at the *1st Annual PBS Research Symposium, Johns Hopkins University*.

Pan, W., & Cox, J. (2024). The Effects of Lexical Proficiency in Bilinguals' Personality Test Results. Poster presented at the *DREAMS 2024 Fall Research Symposium, Johns Hopkins University*.

Pan, W., Bern, R., & Eastwick, P. (2024). Openness and Compersion: The Association Between Openness and Compersion in Consensually Nonmonogamous Romantic Relationships. Poster presented at the *9th ASPIRE Annual Research Symposium, University of California, Davis*.

RESEARCH AND PROJECT EXPERIENCES

Expectations, Experiences, and Reflections on Valentine's Day

Supervised by Dr. Jeffrey Bowen, SPARC Lab, Johns Hopkins University

Jan 2026 – Present

- Examined how temporal landmarks (Valentine's Day) influence both singles' and couples' expectations and experiences in romantic relationships.
- Arranged experimental preparation, administered informed consent to participants, and addressed emergencies during study sessions.

Social Media Stream-of-Consciousness

Supervised by Dr. Jeffrey Bowen, SPARC Lab, Johns Hopkins University

Jun 2025 – Present

- Examined psychological factors that shape individuals' experiences and reactions in naturalistic social media settings to address gaps where most studies relied heavily on artificially edited or preselected posts.
- Conducted literature review to summarize lab reports; transcribed interview audio into words and highlighted key contents; assisted in data cleaning and analyzed qualitative data.
- Developed guidelines to classify emotions into two dimensions (emotional valence and emotional arousal); collaborated to label emotions and resolve discrepancies to ensure data consistency and reliability.
- Identified that posts with positive emotions and higher emotional arousal were more likely to be shared within social media, while higher relatability is also a key motivation for social media sharing.

Virtual Intimacy and Attachment in Player-Character Relationships within Dating Simulation Games

Independent project, DREAM Lab & SPARC Lab, Johns Hopkins University

Feb 2025 – Present

- Investigated the psychological mechanisms of intimacy and parasocial relationships in dating simulation games to examine how individuals perceive attachment and emotional bonds with virtual characters.
- Integrated validated psychological scales (ECR, TPI, etc.) with game elements to design surveys via Qualtrics; developed novel items such as realism belief to operationalize and measure variables.
- Recruited 400 participants and completed IRB approval and OSF preregistration; performed data cleaning and descriptive statistical analysis (correlation, multiple regression, interaction models) in R, resulting in a high-quality poster to be presented at the SPSP 2026 Annual Convention.
- Concluded that attachment styles significantly affect the boundary permeability between the virtual and the real in players' relationships with game characters, with attachment anxiety positively associated with all indicators of boundary permeability, whereas attachment avoidance negatively associated with these outcomes.

Modified Representational Media in Psychological Self-report Measurement

Supervised by Dr. Jeffrey Bowen, SPARC Lab, Johns Hopkins University

Aug 2025 – Present

- Investigated how abstract and concrete representations of romantic partners in common self-report measurements influence individuals' thoughts, feelings, and attitudes.
- Arranged experimental preparation, administered informed consent and debriefing to participants, coordinated 50+ participants in experiment sessions and addressed emergencies during study sessions.

The Relationship Between Helicopter Parenting and Romantic Beliefs

Course project, supervised by Dr. Jeffrey Bowen, Johns Hopkins University

Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Investigated the impact of maladaptive parenting styles on children's intimate relationship development.

- Used Qualtrics to design questionnaires and recruited 50 participants on SONA; conducted data cleaning and statistical analyses using R (t-test, one-way ANOVA, and two-way factorial ANOVA).
- Drafted a 3,000-word academic paper, contributing to the research about how early family dynamics shape children's later romantic relationships.

Parental Psychological Control and Effects on Chinese Adolescents: Mental Health and Academic Performance

Course project, supervised by Dr. Cui, Johns Hopkins University

Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Investigated the effects of parental psychological control (guilt induction, love withdrawal, and shaming) on Chinese adolescents' mental health and academic performance.
- Generated a 2,000-word final paper; designed posters to demonstrate the negative effects of parental psychological control, suggesting possible directions for future research on adolescent development.

Personality, Language Ability, and Stereotypes

Independent project, supervised by Dr. Jonah Cox, University of California, Davis

Nov 2023 – Apr 2025

- Examined how personality traits (agreeableness) and English proficiency shape Chinese students' stereotypes of native speakers, addressing gaps where stereotypes about agreeableness were predominantly negative.
- Drafted research proposal, secured Provost's Undergraduate Fellowship and completed IRB approval.
- Designed and implemented questionnaires via Qualtrics and SONA, recruited 150 participants.
- Conducted data cleaning and analysis using SPSS and Excel (regression analysis and modeling); visualized through interaction plot with R; resulting in a poster presented at two research symposiums.
- Identified a significantly positive association between agreeableness and positive stereotypes of native speakers, with English proficiency as a significant moderator, contributing to research on stereotypes and personality.

Understanding Polyamorous Relationship Dynamics

Supervised by Dr. Paul Eastwick, Relationship and Attraction Lab, University of California, Davis

Nov 2022 – Jun 2024

- Examined how personality traits (openness to experience) influence compersion among individuals in consensually non-monogamous (CNM) relationships to investigate how personality traits shape romantic experiences in this understudied population.
- Assisted in designing questionnaires using Qualtrics, including survey flow and logic; resulting in a poster presented at a research symposium.
- Identified a significant positive correlation between openness and compersion in CNM relationships, contributing to research on personality and intimate relationships.

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Oak Education, Psychology Tutor, Shenzhen, China

Jul 2025 – Sept 2025

- Designed and taught a 10-week individualized research methods course (1-on-1) for two high school students, covering topics such as research methodology, ethics, and experimental vs. non-experimental designs.
- Mentored students in advanced statistical techniques and developing research proposals, collecting and analyzing data, and making academic posters.

ESC Summer Camp, Peer Mentor, Shanghai, China

Jul 2024 – Aug 2024

- Designed and taught a course on *Personality Psychology* for 35 middle school students, integrating interactive activities and personality assessments to encourage students' participation.

University of California, Davis, Chinese Tutor, Davis, CA

Sept 2023 – Dec 2023

- Reviewed students' assignments, developed individualized study plans, and strengthened their oral communication skills through one-on-one practice sessions and prompt feedback.
- Facilitated cultural activities to encourage student engagement in the tutorial program.

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY ACTIVITIES

Codesfox, an AI-powered platform that helps users turn their project ideas into functional web applications.

Startup Co-founder

Dec 2024 – Jun 2025

- Conducted user and market analysis through surveys, interviews, and competitive benchmarking to define target users, create personas, and refine product strategy.
- Coordinated and facilitated usability testing sessions, synthesized user feedback to optimize navigation patterns and accessibility, and presented pitch deck to enhance product visibility.

Biz UP, a student-led organization dedicated to bridging the information gap for Chinese students in accessing education.

Core Team Member

Jun 2023 – Oct 2024

- Planned and hosted live online broadcasts featuring 18 admissions officers from top universities and 10+ prominent business leaders, attracting a total audience of over 25,000 viewers.

Conch Psychological Club

Co-founder, University of California, Davis

Sept 2022 – Jun 2024

- Launched the "Conch is Listening" initiative, and offered support by helping them navigate stress.
- Organized weekly events to foster community through story-sharing and informal conversation, receiving 100% positive feedback and 92% interest in attending future events.

SKILLS

- **Technical Skills:** R, SPSS, Excel, MATLAB, Python, Java, LaTeX.
- **Design & Editing:** Figma, Canva, PowerPoint, Adobe Premiere Pro, Photoshop.
- **Language:** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic).